Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers of the Town Hall on Monday, June 17, 2019 at 7:00 p.m.

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 Regular Meeting – May 21, 2019

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of Council held on May 21, 2019 be adopted.

CARRIED

3.2 Special Meeting – May 27, 2019

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the Minutes of the special meeting of Council held on May 27, 2019 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Question Period

Cathy Hollis, Ajax resident, addressed Council regarding item 4.13 of the General Government Committee Report of June 10, 2019 - Paradise Park Washroom Facility & Site Improvements. Ms. Hollis noted that there is a need among residents and users of the park for the washroom facilities, and that other amenities already constructed at the park require the installation of a washroom facility. She asked that Council reconsider its decision at the General Government Committee and approve the installation of the washroom facilities at Paradise Park.

Council Members asked questions of Ms. Hollis regarding how residents and users currently utilize the public space without a washroom facility, and the provisions within the Town's capital expenditure control policy. Ms. Hollis responded to questions from Council Members.

5. Delegation and Petitions/Public Hearings

Motion to Suspend the Rules of Procedure

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the rules of procedure be suspended in order to introduce an unscheduled delegation regarding the Region of Durham Strategic Plan.

CARRIED ON 2/3RDS

5.1 National Indigenous Peoples Day

Jai Sahak, Diversity and Community Engagement Coordinator, discussed the Town's efforts to engage Indigenous Peoples within Ajax, and reviewed events and activities in 2019 in support of Indigenous Peoples. J. Sahak introduced Mary Kelly, Ojibways of Onigaming, who shared her experience with the residential school system in Canada and discussed the purpose of National Indigenous Peoples Day. Ms. Kelly requested that Council proclaim June 21st as National Indigenous Peoples Day in Ajax.

Council Members thanked Ms. Kelly for her delegation and asked questions regarding National Indigenous Peoples Day recognitions across the country. Ms. Kelly responded to questions from Council Members. Mayor Collier presented the proclamation on behalf of Council.

5.2 Sovereign's Medal for Volunteers Recipient: Judith Gonzales, Resident of Ajax

Judith Gonzales, Ajax resident, introduced herself and thanked her family, friends, and fellow volunteers for their support. Mayor Collier noted that the Sovereign's Medal for Volunteers is awarded by her Excellency the Right Honourable Julie Payette, Governor General of Canada, in recognition of exceptional volunteer achievements in a wide range of fields through significant and sustained efforts. Mayor Collier reviewed Ms. Gonzales' volunteering efforts in support of Filipino immigrants and caregivers, and her fundraising efforts for charitable causes in the Phillipines. Mayor Collier congratulated Ms. Gonzales and presented her with the Sovereign's Medal for Volunteers.

5.3 Letter of Support – Negative Changes to the Ontario Autism Program

Suzi Panovska-Guarrasi, Ajax Parent Advocate, introduced herself and discussed changes to funding for needs-based therapy for children with autism in Ontario made by the Provincial Government. Ms. Panovska-Guarrasi discussed her experience with Applied Behaviour Analysis, cost to provide needs-based therapy for children with autism, and negative impacts of the changes to the provincial funding model. Ms. Panovska-Guarrasi asked that Council provide a letter of support on behalf of the community.

Elisha Chesler, owner of Sunshine Learning Centre, reviewed her background and experience with providing Applied Behaviour Analysis in Ajax. Ms. Chesler explained how needs-based therapy works and discussed challenges with demand for service, implications of changes to the funding model, and loss of capacity to provide service as a result of the funding changes.

Council Members asked questions regarding how the provincial funding model operates, wait times to receive funding, effectiveness of needs-based therapies, waitlist for services, out of pocket costs for parents, and resources available through the school system. Ms. Panovska-Guarrasi reviewed wait times for funding under the new funding model. Ms. Chesler discussed the effectiveness and benefits of needs-based therapies and reviewed costs for families, wait times for service at her facility, and limited resources available through the school system. Council Members thanked Ms. Panovska-Guarrasi and Ms. Chesler for their delegation and noted the resolution on this matter later in the agenda.

5.4 Library Board Update

Noel Green, Library Board Chair, reviewed the contents of the Library Board's written report and noted that the Library Board was appointed by Council for the new term of office in December of 2018. Mr. Green discussed the contents of the written report, including customer feedback, library open house, Accessible Ajax, new board members, the TD Summer Reading Club, and Learn for Life campaign.

Council Members asked questions regarding new and diverse programming offered by the library, and availability of library materials in alternative formats for users with accessibility needs. Mr. Green discussed the library's focus on technology and diverse programming available to library users. Donna Bright, Chief Librarian, Ajax Public Library, reviewed accessible formats including audio books available to library users. Council Members thanked Mr. Green and Ms. Bright for their delegation.

5.5 2019 Construction Update

Catherine Bridgeman, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, provided a presentation on various construction projects occurring in 2019. C. Bridgeman reviewed design and construction projects for sidewalks, trails, parks, parking lots, roads, culverts, storm sewers, pathways, and streetlight installations in the Town. She provided an update on plans and studies being undertaken, as well as major construction projects being undertaken by the Region of Durham in Ajax for 2019.

Council Members asked questions regarding the Church Street bridge and road reconstruction, sidewalk construction near Kirkham Drive, walkway lighting installations, new website for capital projects, and design standards for complete streets that include both multi-use trails and on-street bike lanes. C. Bridgeman responded to questions from Council Members and reviewed the Church Street bridge and road reconstruction project, sidewalk installations, walkway lighting installation projects, design and construction process, and the new construction project website. Dave Meredith, Director of Planning & Development Services, reviewed the Town's design elements for complete streets. Council Members thanked Ms. Bridgeman for her presentation.

Motion to Suspend the Rules of Procedure

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the rules of procedure be suspended in order to advance item 9.2 in the order of business.

CARRIED ON 2/3RDS

9.2 Autism Funding - Councillor Bower & Regional Councillor Lee

Councillor Bower introduced the motion and asked for Council's support. Regional Councillor Lee noted his support for the motion and discussed concerns with the new provincial funding model. Council Members discussed the contents of the motion.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: S. Lee

WHEREAS in February 2019, the Provincial Government introduced a new service delivery approach and funding programs to address waitlists for treatment and other challenges within the existing Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD) support system, starting May 1;

AND WHEREAS considerable concerns have been expressed about the new program and funding changes (i.e. inadequate funding, reduced flexibility, and lack of training/resources within classrooms) by a broad variety of stakeholders, including Autism Ontario, parents, and health professionals;

AND WHEREAS the Minister of Children, Community and Social Services conducted further consultation throughout the month of May to help inform the government on ways to better support those with complex ASD needs, and recently created a 20-member panel to consider consultation feedback and make recommendations on a needs-based funding model;

AND WHEREAS ASD is one of the most common developmental disabilities in Canada, with 1 in 66 children diagnosed with ASD, and evidence shows that when children start behavioural intervention between ages 2 and 5, they gain improvements in cognitive and language development, are better prepared for school, and have better long-term outcomes in adulthood;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT Ajax Council formally requests that the Minister of Children, Community and Social Services continues to work collaboratively with families, community partners and stakeholders to develop a needs-based funding model to ensure every person with ASD has access to the specialized programming, therapies and service providers they need to thrive within their communities;

AND THAT a copy of this resolution be forwarded to Premier Ford, Minister Fedeli, Minister MacLeod, members of provincial parliament within the Region of Durham, local school boards, Association of Municipalities of Ontario, and Autism Ontario.

CARRIED

RECORDED VOTE:

In Favour: Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Khan, Councillor Tyler Morin, Mayor Collier
Opposed: None

5.6 Strategic Plan Update

Christie McLardie, Manager of Public & Strategic Affairs, delivered a presentation on the Corporate Strategic Plan. C. McLardie discussed the history of strategic planning in Ajax, setting priorities to reach common goals, the purpose of strategic planning, guiding Council to the future, building the new strategic plan, framework for the draft plan, the community promise, focus areas, staff consultations, developing the strategic actions, and next steps.

Council Members asked questions regarding outcomes of the strategic planning sessions held in February, and future opportunities to review the draft strategic plan. C. McLardie responded to questions from Council Members and reviewed timelines for the completed draft strategic plan. Council Members thanked Ms. McLardie for her presentation.

5.7 Artificial Intelligence Initiatives

Lisa Hausz, Manager of Economic Development & Tourism, discussed innovation and technology events and workshops held in Ajax in support of the local workforce. L. Hausz reviewed Town and Regional initiatives held throughout 2019 and noted that an update regarding an innovation hub and business incubator in Ajax will be forthcoming.

Council Members asked questions regarding the upcoming Cyber Olympics event, 5G deployment in Ajax, and vision for the innovation hub. L. Hausz responded to questions from Council Members.

5.8 Durham Region Strategic Plan Update

Sonya Hardman, Manager of Corporate Initiatives, discussed the Region of Durham's strategic planning process and reviewed upcoming public engagement activities for residents to comment on the Region's strategic plan development. Council Members thanked Ms. Hardman for her presentation.

6. Correspondence

Council Members separated item vi) 'Castlefields Community Petition' from the correspondence report for discussion. Members discussed the contents of the petition and noted that the matter has not yet proceeded through the development application process and associated statutory public meetings, where there will be opportunities for direct public feedback.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the report dated June 17, 2019 containing Items of Correspondence be adopted.

CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report

Council Members separated item 4.1 from the report for discussion.

Mayor Collier provided an overview of subsequent discussions with the proponent of the development application, and proposed a referral back to staff to consider further changes to the proposed development application. Council Members asked questions regarding the process to bring the matter back to Council for a final decision. D. Meredith discussed the referral process, consultations with the applicant to consider alternative proposals, and subsequent reporting back to a public meeting for review of any proposed changes.

Referral Motion

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That item 4.1 of the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report for June 3, 2019, be referred back to staff for further consideration.

CARRIED

Main Motion

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated June 3, 2019 be adopted, as amended.

CARRIED

7.2 General Government Committee Report

Council Members separated item 4.13 from the report for discussion.

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Deputy Mayor Crawford assumed the Chair.

Mayor Collier introduced an amending motion regarding item 4.13 of the report - Paradise Park Washroom Facility & Site Improvements, and reviewed the contents of the amending motion. Council Members discussed the proposed amendment, the over-budget amount for the project, and the Town's capital expenditure control policy.

GGC Recommendation – Item 4.13

That the contract for the Paradise Park Washroom Facility and Site Improvements be cancelled, and that staff be directed to report back to Council with options and costs to complete the landscaping and trail connection portion to be considered in the 2020 capital budget.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the recommendation within the General Government Committee Report regarding item 4.13 be amended to read as follows:

1. That the contract for the Paradise Park Washroom Facility and Site Improvements be cancelled, and that staff be directed to complete the following works at Paradise Park in 2019:
    a. Soft landscaping – planting, sodding, shrubs, trees and topsoil
    b. Hard landscaping – connect trails from the road to the parking lot, and from the parking lot to the trail; and
    c. Valve box installation for servicing connections.

2. That upon completion of the work identified in this resolution, the unused funds be re-allocated to the Development Reserve from Capital Account 10003611; and

3. That staff be directed to report back to Council with alternative design options for the Paradise Park washrooms in 2020.

CARRIED

RECORDED VOTE:

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Councillor Khan, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Crawford
Opposed: Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Dies

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

Main Motion

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the General Government Committee Report dated June 10, 2019, be adopted, as amended.

CARRIED

7.3 Summary of Advisory Committee Activities

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the Summary of Advisory Committee Activities dated June 17, 2019 as attached to the meeting agenda be received for information, and that the recommendations contained therein be referred to staff where applicable.

CARRIED

7.4 Departmental Reports

7.4.1 Ajax Public Library Board Update

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the Library Board Update be received for information.

CARRIED

7.4.2 Contract Award ~ Level of Service Strategic Plan

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: A. Khan

1. That Council award the contract for Asset Level of Service Strategic Plan, to GHD Limited in the amount of $435,215.12 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Council approve funding of $31,117.17 to be allocated to Capital Account No. 1009011 from Federal Gas Tax Reserve.

CARRIED

8. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Councillor Crawford referred to the contents of the written report. There were no questions from Members of Council.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of June 17, 2019 be received for information.

CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Deputy Mayor Crawford assumed the Chair.

9.1 William A. Parish Waterfront Trail – Mayor Collier & Regional Councillor Crawford

Mayor Collier introduced the motion. Council Members discussed the legacy of former mayor William A. Parish and his historic contributions to the Town of Ajax.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: M. Crawford

WHEREAS William A. Parish (1924-2018), a graduate of the University of Toronto and teacher, moved to Ajax in 1952 with his young family to be head of the History Department of the newly opened Pickering District High School in Pickering Village;

AND WHEREAS Mr. Parish became involved in Town affairs and was the Chairman of the Ajax Citizens Association, which fought for and won the struggle in 1954 to make the Improvement District of Ajax a "Town" with its own elected Council;

AND WHEREAS Mr. Parish served on the Town's first Council in 1955, was elected again in 1956 and 1957, and then became the Town's third Mayor in 1958, serving six terms until 1963;

AND WHEREAS during his tenure as Mayor, Mr. Parish enacted the Town's first Official Plan, which designated a 400 foot wide strip of Ajax Waterfront as publicly owned open space and greenbelt for the enjoyment of the entire community;

AND WHEREAS Mr. Parish also established the Town's first publicly owned water filtration plant to ensure a clean water supply for the community, and secure Ajax as an industrial and commercial leader in the County of Ontario (now Region of Durham);

AND WHEREAS the protection of the Ajax Waterfront against private development was an accomplishment Mr. Parish was particularly proud of, describing it as one of the most far-sighted decisions the Councils of 1958 and 1959 made;

AND WHEREAS today, the Ajax Waterfront is a gem of unspoiled beauty which includes over 240 acres of land with passive recreational space, community pavilions, parks and a seven-kilometre Waterfront Trail, and is considered one of the most picturesque waterfronts in southern Ontario;

AND WHEREAS the Ajax Waterfront Trail is now part of the Great Lakes Waterfront Trail that stretches 3,000 kilometres from Gros Cap to South Glengarry and is also part of the Trans-Canada Trail;

AND WHEREAS Mr. Parish received the Ajax Civic Award in 2005 – the highest honour available to a Town of Ajax resident – for his dedication and continued support of the community. He led and was involved with countless community organizations, including Friends of the Ajax/Pickering Hospital, Pickering Ajax Citizens Together, and the John Howard Society. He was also known as the Town's unofficial historian, believing it was important to honour and share the unique history of Ajax. For this, he posthumously received the Town of Ajax Heritage Community Award in 2018;

AND WHEREAS Mr. Parish lived in Ajax for 66 years until his passing in 2018 at the age of 94;

NOW THEREFORE IT BE RESOLVED THAT in honour of William A. Parish's dedication to the development, growth and prosperity of the Town of Ajax, the Ajax Waterfront Trail be renamed to the ***William A. Parish Waterfront Trail***;

AND THAT staff be directed to install two William A. Parish Waterfront Trail signs and associated plaques and/or information panels at the east and west sections of the trail by the end of summer 2019, coordinate an official unveiling event, and update Town of Ajax promotional material and waterfront signage with stakeholders as necessary.

CARRIED

RECORDED VOTE:

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Khan, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Crawford
Opposed: None

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

10. By-laws

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That By-law numbers 36-2019 to 46-2019 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

None

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members noted upcoming events, including 'Live With Mayor Collier' on June 24th, Ward 1 Community Meeting on June 25th, and Ward 2 Community Meeting on June 26th. Council Members discussed recently held events including 'Jurassic Park of the East' and Mayor's Gala. Council Members thanked staff for their hard work and dedication on the 'Jurassic Park of the East' event.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: A. Khan

That By-law number 47-2019 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its regular meeting held on June 17, 2019 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the June 17 2019 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned. (9:33 p.m.)

CARRIED

Mayor

Deputy Clerk